



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate

JUL 2021

July

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Are you on
Facebook?
Join our private
Minnehaha
Community Page!

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



Generous Financial Gift

Some of you may have seen the article in the newspaper from a few weeks ago. One of our members, Pam Olson, died back in December, and she made a number of generous gifts in her will. The article was about her \$2.3 million donation to the Twin Cities chapter of the Big Brothers/Big Sisters Society. It's a wonderful article about Pam, her humble awareness of her luck in having financial resources, her own volunteer work as a Big Sister, and her generous nature. If you have a chance to find it, I highly recommend reading it. The article mentions other recipients in her will, including Minnehaha UMC. While we haven't received a check yet (wills can take a notoriously long time to sort out), we have been informed that we will receive \$100,000 from Pam's will. We are incredibly grateful to Pam's generosity, and to the ways in which she enlivened the congregation during her time with us. We do have guidelines for gifts like this, and you probably remember that we have talked about previous gifts from members (like Howard Bogart) that have been a huge help to us. Howard's gift is partly responsible for the work we have been able to do on the lower level of the church building, including the gym. Pam's gift will be divided 4 ways, 3 parts into our various investment funds and 1 part into our operating budget, unless the Finance Committee and Trustees and Church Council vote to distribute it differently. We have already been in conversation about the best use of this gift, which might be something like trying to retire a major portion of the debt remaining on our 2010 renovations of the building. You'll be hearing more this fall regarding that. In the meantime, offer up a prayer of thanks for Pam and her generosity. And, consider putting the church in your will as well. You don't have to give us \$100,000 (although we wouldn't discourage that!); every amount matters. Our 3 investment funds have grown over the years with numbers of small gifts from members' wills.

Worship in July

Throughout the month of July, our scripture readings will continue to come from the Letters section of the Bible. We'll start with worship on the 4th of July as we balance taking pride in our country with humility. And we'll end the month by hearing from a guest preacher, Sarah Schroerlucke. You may remember that Sarah is a candidate for ministry – she is looking to become a full time chaplain. Which is great news for us, because we'll still get to “keep” her as part of the congregation while she gets to fulfill this calling. We look forward to seeing you in person on the lawn, or “seeing you” virtually as you worship with us online.

July 4	“Letters Across the Divide: Exceptionalism”	II Corinthians 12:2-10
July 11	“People of God”	Ephesians 1:3-14
July 18	“All For One and One For All”	Ephesians 2:11-22
July 25	“Rooted and Grounded in Love”	Ephesians 3:14-21

Water & weed.
Connect & laugh.
Wonder & appreciate.
Meet the worms.
Smell the oregano.
Watch the cucamelons climb.
Chase a butterfly.

Many thanks to all those
who've already put in lots of
work to create this space - we
hope you all will join us...



the
**MINNEHAHA
GARDEN**

**WE NEED YOUR
HELP: SIGN-UP
TODAY!!**



JULY

July sees the return to in-person camps at Minnehaha. First, we'll have Vacation Bible School. This year our theme is "Celebrate Creation" and throughout our time together, we'll be working on appreciating creation and all its diversity, and also (and especially) how we are called to care for creation. We'll do this intergenerationally - inviting families to come together (not just dropping off kids). Our opening will be on Sunday, July 18th in the afternoon, and we'll continue Monday, Tuesday, and Wednesday evenings, with dinner options available during the weekdays. We're encouraging families to come to as much as they can - but also will have all the resources available online - so no worries if you can only make one or two of the in-person opportunities - we'd still love to have you join us as we celebrate creation together!

You can find more information on the flier within this newsletter, and online at www.minnehaha.org (where you can also register).

The very next week, we'll have our Music & Drama Camp for first through eighth graders, and culminating in a performance AT Minnehaha Falls Park, as we share stories about this incredible place and the peoples who have lived there. We hope you'll join us for that performance of "Minnehaha Falls: The Musical" on Friday, 30th July at 6:30pm.

Happy Summer, All!

Jenia Strom, Director of Children, Youth, & Family Ministries

MINNEHAHA CAMPING TRIP

Whether you are new to camping or consider yourself a pro, the Minnehaha Camping Trip is an experience not to be missed.

We gather close by, at Baker Park Reserve, so you don't have to worry about a long drive, while still getting a chance to disengage from everyday life. People of all ages join in for a relaxing time to connect and play. Lake Independence is right there, for time in the water if you'd like, and hiking and campfires, and - whatever makes your camping experience complete.

See the flier within the newsletter for more information and register today - camp sites are limited.



YOUTH TUESDAY NIGHTS

Each week this summer, Minnehaha Youth and our absolutely amazing youth volunteer leaders gather together for some adventure together. From biking to lawn games, Ultimate Frisbee and more - it's a chance for us to check in with each other, build relationships, try new things, share favorite activities - it's a chance to be in community! Details for each week's activity are shared in the weekly youth email. Be sure you're on the list - if you're not, contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org

SURVEY COMING - FALL PROGRAMMING

In mid-July, Minnehaha's Reopening Task Force will meet to look at the state of the pandemic, and assess what possibilities there are for programming at Minnehaha in the fall. Shortly thereafter, you'll be receiving a survey to get your feedback on various options. Please keep an eye out for this, and be sure to respond as we want to be sure we are attending to everyone's needs as we plan for the fall. We know continued flexibility and pivoting, creativity and patience will be needed, and thank you in advance for your feedback.

Minnehaha Kids & Their Families are invited
to join us for our next

Minnehaha
Family Fun Event
Wednesday, June 30th
5:30-7pm
at Nokomis Main Beach

We'll enjoy playtime (& dinner, too - if you'd like to
pack a picnic/get food at Sandcastle) together



Meals on Wheels

In addition to our Food Shelf, MinneHarvest, making meals for those at Simpson Shelter or Clare Housing, we also deliver Meals on Wheels to those who are homebound and in regular need of some prepared food. Our team of drivers takes a week of deliveries every 7 weeks or so. When “our” week comes up, Rachel Larson (our coordinator) reaches out to everyone to see who can take which day. There are several routes to be delivered, and you can volunteer for just one of the days, or take on more than one. Each drive rshows up at Nokomis Square around 11:10 a.m., gets their instructions (the route is already carefully mapped out for you), picks up their meals, and heads out. Most routes take about an hour to an hour and a half to deliver, and then you return all empty items back to Nokomis Square.

If you would like to be added to list of potential drivers, please contact Rachel and let her know. Some weeks, all the drivers are ready and able, and we only use some of them. Other weeks, the weather is bad, or some folks are on vacation, or they are prevented from driving for a couple weeks because of medical procedures and then we need more people than we currently have. Thanks for all you do to help the people of our community!

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us on July 24. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend (and a mask)!



WHEN: AUGUST 20-22
WHERE: BAKER PARK RESERVE
 ON LAKE INDEPENDENCE
 (JUST A 40 MINUTE DRIVE
 FROM SOUTH MINNEAPOLIS)
COST: \$53.23/FAMILY FOR TWO NIGHTS

RSVP TO BETH MINEHART AT
 952.232.7711



MINNEHAHA UMC INVITES YOU TO

Celebrate Creation: an Intergenerational VBS

Come together as families for activities, music,
stories and more that help us celebrate and
consider how we care for creation

**Sunday, July 18 from 3-4:30PM &
Monday, July 19, Tuesday, July 20, &
Wednesday July 21 from 6-7:30pm**

Dinner options will be available at 5:30pm on the 19th-21st

COST PER FAMILY \$10

All materials will also be available
online. Come in person for what
you can! We will be outside and
following Covid-precautions.

REGISTER at www.minnehaha.org





United
Methodist
Women

United Methodist Women

Seems like (writing this in June) we may be getting back to normal, if 90 degree weather is normal in Minnesota! How grand to see other complete faces and to hug or handshake others! Women of Minnehaha UMC, as in our UMW which all women are members of, had a fine, and hot time, on Tuesday, June 8 just getting together, sharing stories and snacks on my deck, wishing for a breeze! It was really nice to connect with old and new friends.

SEPTEMBER RUMMAGE SALE!!! Hold on to all that rummage you've accumulated over the year and bring it to MUMC on Sunday, Aug. 29 or Sunday Sept. 5 to be sorted and readied for a fall Rummage Sale on Sept. 9-11. Please don't bring it any sooner (no place to store). We'll be selling, hopefully in the Fellowship Hall, thru the 50th St. door unless all restrictions have been lifted. No clothing or large furniture and everything should be in working order. The rummage sale will benefit both MUMC and UMW but....you need to help out. There's many opportunities to volunteer to prep for the sale and work at it and buy stuff! We'll begin recruiting you soon or just let Maureen know you want to help that week, Sept. 6-11.

Coming in September: back to serving at Simpson Shelter! They are opening back up to groups coming in who have prepared a dinner meal for 110 and serving at the Shelter at 28th St. and 1st Ave. So. We will be serving monthly with the following dates chosen: Wed., Sept. 29, Mon. Oct. 27 and Mon.

Nov. 29. Funding for the meals is from the UMW budget which had a pandemic hit when we needed to cancel some of our fundraising events. Hopefully we will have a successful Rummage Sale! Please let me know if you'd like to help out with cooking or serving on these dates. Maureen Trepp at maureentrepp@yahoo.com

We have served to 25 people at Clare Housing, Midtown branch from Feb. until August. Great

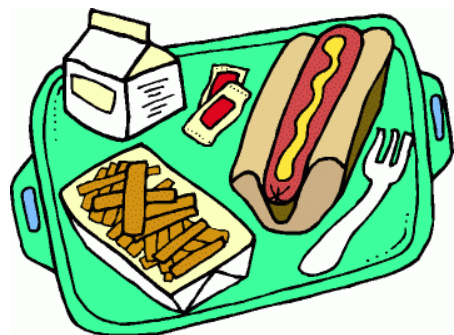
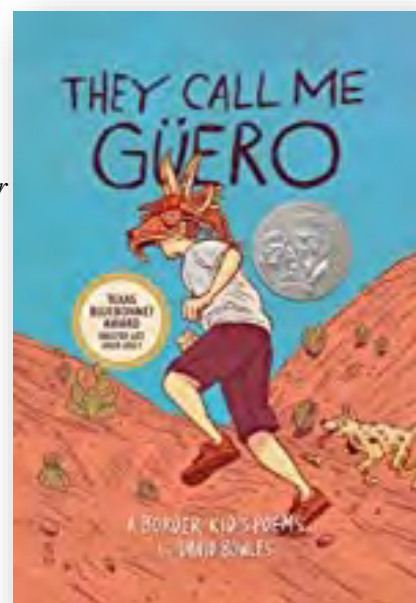
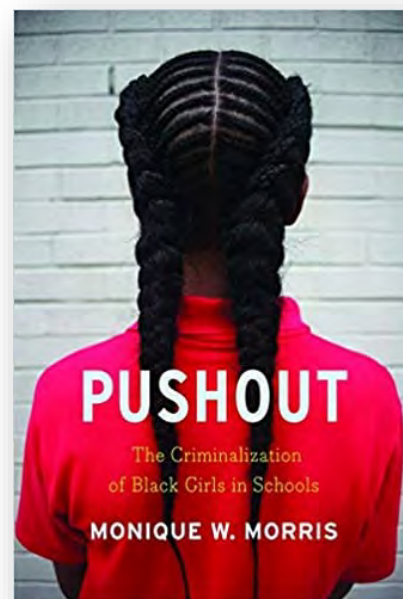
thanks to John Darlington, Julie Darlington, Margaret Rawson, Sue Johnson, Mary Heltsley, Peter Werner, Dave Noren and Kitty Campbell for preparing and delivering meals.

Some new recommendations from the UMW Reading Program:

PUSHOUT: THE CRIMINALIZATION OF BLACK GIRLS IN SCHOOLS — MONIQUE W. MORRIS *Despite increased attention to the mass and over-incarceration of Black men, the plight of criminalized Black women and girls is overlooked, underreported and under-analyzed.*

THEY CALL ME GÜERO: A BORDER KID'S POEMS — DAVID BOWLES *Güero is Mexican American, at home on both sides of the river. He's starting seventh grade with a woke English teacher who knows how to make poetry cool.*

Please continue to stay well, come to outdoor church, collect rummage and water that garden! Peace to you and yours,
Maureen Trepp, UMW President



join us for a
Minnehaha Music & Drama Camp Performance of

Minnehaha Falls: The Musical

Enjoy Stories, Songs and Dances as you travel the
History of Minnehaha Falls and its People

Friday, 30th July at 6:30 pm

At Minnehaha Falls Park

Bring your own camp chairs/blanket

Performance begins at the pergola north of the
Stevens House, on the ridge on the upper southwest
side of the falls. Then, we'll continue throughout the
park, guided by the actors.

In case of rain, check
www.minnehaha.org for
performance plans.



Animal Blessing

Animals play an important role in many of our lives. If you have a special pet, we invite you to bring it to our annual animal blessing service on Sunday, August 29. We'll gather inside if it is raining, but either way, there will be a time in the worship service to have your pet blessed. Whether you have a horse or a hamster, bring them to church. Just make sure it's in a crate or container or on leash of some kind. If you don't have a pet, but wish you did, come anyway, and bring a stuffed animal if you'd like. If your pet doesn't like crowds, other animals, or can't really get out, bring a picture and we'll bless that. You may also wish to recognize the death of a pet in this way. And, invite your friends to bring their pets as well; we welcome everyone.

Worship and Potluck Picnic at the Falls

On Sunday, August 1 we will be joining with other congregations in our neighborhood for a worship service at Minnehaha Falls Park. The service will be held at the band shell and will begin at 10:30. Assuming that our Covid numbers remain low throughout the summer, masks will most likely be optional.

Note that if you need accessible parking, it is available near the pavilion and gives you a level path to the band shell.

For those of you unable to make it, the service will be recorded, and we will upload it to our YouTube channel (with a link on our website) by Sunday afternoon.





Cautious Hope

Hope. A word used often in Christian circles, but it means different things at different times. These days, I have cautious hope. Which means, I want to assume the best, but I also don't want to ignore how quickly things can go bad. I used to blithely plan things a year or a year and a half in advance. It helps me to know in advance what kind of sermon series I am thinking of doing so that I can do research and collect resources. It helps the musicians to know what themes are coming up so they can be looking for (and sometimes ordering) appropriate music. Often, we try to coordinate our education program with the worship themes, and curriculum has to be ordered months in advance of our use. But, these days, my planning has a much smaller window. Both the reality of this pandemic and the reality of the violence and issues being raised around us make it much harder to know what will be important to address next January, much less next summer. So, I look ahead a couple months, do some broad outlines that can be tweaked, and try not to get too far behind. As I look to the fall, I have cautious hope. Our Covid statistics give me hope. The number of vaccines, and their continued efficacy against the variants, and the plans to eventually have them available for all ages gives me hope. The creation of our Racial Justice Committee gives me hope. The continued commitment of most of the bishops in the United Methodist Church to put on the back burner punitive responses to LGBTQ persons and those doing weddings gives me hope. The creation of our Climate Sustainability Committee gives me hope. I have absolute hope that we are embarking on a new road, a road that is more just and more sustainable. I have cautious hope that we can engage on issues side by side, not just on screens. I have absolute hope that we are committed to raising a new generation of human beings who are compassionate and who see the humanity in all persons. I have absolute hope that we are committed to doing the same for ourselves, and not just for our children. I have cautious hope that we will actually see the tide begin to turn. That our sustainable climate choices will begin to impact our environment positively. That our work on justice will result in better policing, better educational systems, better housing.

As we progress through summer, with its invitation to play, to laugh, to soak up the warmth and sun, I invite us all to pick up some cautious hope. Let us do the work God calls us to with absolute hope. And let us have cautious hope about the variety of ways in which we will be able to engage in this work.

In Joy,

Becky



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7/21



Save the Date

Here are some events coming up this summer. While we know that things can change quickly, we are fairly confident that these events will take place:

- ★ Sunday, July 18 – Wednesday, July 21 – Modified Vacation Bible School
- ★ Monday, July 26 – Friday, July 30 -- Modified Music & Drama Camp
- ★ Sunday, August 1 at 10:30 a.m. – Ecumenical worship held at Minnehaha Falls Park
- ★ Friday, Aug. 20 – Sunday, Aug. 22 – Minnehaha Camping Weekend at Baker Lake Park
- ★ Sunday, Aug. 29 – Blessing of the Animals during worship